

PIXELGATE — Setup & Run Checklist

1. Install required software

They need:

- **Node.js** — install the LTS version
- **MongoDB Community Server**
- **VS Code** — recommended

After installing Node.js, check:

```
node -v  
npm -v
```

Check MongoDB:

```
Get-Service MongoDB
```

It should show:

```
Running    MongoDB
```

2. Get the project

Copy/clone the complete project:

```
gaming-blog/  
├─ frontend/  
└─ backend/
```

Make sure **both folders** are present.

3. Backend setup

Open PowerShell:

```
cd path\to\gaming-blog\backend
```

Install backend dependencies:

```
npm install
```

Make sure the backend `.env` file exists and has the correct MongoDB connection settings.

Then populate the database:

```
node seed.js
```

 `seed.js` creates the initial admin, categories and sample posts. **Don't run it repeatedly on a database containing real data**, because it deletes existing users, categories and posts first.

4. Start the backend

In the backend folder:

```
npm start
```

They should see:

```
✓ Connected to MongoDB
🚀 Server running at http://localhost:5000
```

Keep this terminal open.

5. Frontend setup

Open a **second PowerShell window**:

```
cd path\to\gaming-blog\frontend
```

Install frontend dependencies:

```
npm install
```

Then start React:

```
npm start
```

They should see:

```
Compiled successfully!  
Local: http://localhost:3000
```

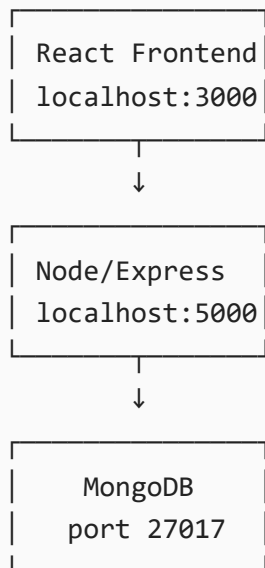
Keep this terminal open too.

6. Open the website

Go to:

```
http://localhost:3000
```

The flow is:



★ Short version to keep in your notes

1. Install Node.js + MongoDB.
2. Get the gaming-blog project.
3. Start MongoDB service.
4. Backend → npm install
5. Backend → node seed.js (first setup only)
6. Backend → npm start
7. Frontend → npm install

8. Frontend → `npm start`
9. Open `http://localhost:3000`

Important: They need **two terminals running simultaneously** — one for the backend and one for the frontend.